Yara Sleiman

Contact

Department of Government
London School of Economics and Political Science
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Fields

Political behaviour; Political psychology; Experimental methods

Academic Appointments

London School of Economics and Political Science — Sept 2026 – present
Department of Government
Postdoctoral Fellow

Education

Queen Mary University of London — 2023 – 2026
PhD in Political Science
Title: *Political Decision-Making under Cross-Pressures*
Supervisors: Prof. Maria Grasso and Dr. Sofia Collignon
HSS PhD Scholarship

University College London — 2022 – 2023
MPhil in Political Science (Passed with no corrections)
Supervisors: Dr. Thomas Gift and Dr. Adam Harris

Lebanese American University — 2018 – 2020
MA in Applied Economics (Distinction)
Graduate Assistantship Scholarship

Lebanese American University — 2015 – 2018
BSc in Economics (High Distinction; Valedictorian)
Honours Scholarship

Publications

Sleiman, Y. (2026). Religious cross-pressures and electoral decision making. *British Journal of Political Science* 56, e51.

Sleiman, Y., Grasso, M., Pattie, C., Serra, L., & Hofer, C. (2026). Polarising punchlines: The influence of intergroup humour on affective political polarisation. *Political Studies*.

Sleiman, Y., Melios, G., & Dolan, P. (2024). Partisan sorting in online dating. *Political Science Research and Methods*.

Sleiman, Y., & Fakih, A. (2022). The gender gap in political participation: Evidence from the MENA region. *Review of Political Economy*.

Revise & Resubmit

Sleiman, Y. Group cross-pressures and correct voting in American elections. *Electoral Studies*.

Sleiman, Y. Public responses to domestic disasters: Evidence from a quasi-experiment in Beirut. *Acta Politica*.

Working Papers

Sleiman, Y., & Melios, G. Thinking twice? How language shapes what voters remember.

Sleiman, Y., & Melios, G. Partisan bias in judgement and learning: A meta-reanalysis.

Sleiman, Y., & Melios, G. Representation without voice: The value of political expression in the age of AI.

Grants (RA)

MultiPoD: Multilingual and Multicultural Spaces for Political Deliberation. Horizon Europe (2023–2026).

Understanding the Power of Political Humour. ESRC, UK (2024).

Levelling Up Dashboard. ESRC Rebuilding Macroeconomics Grant (2022).

Re-framing Prosperity through Education in the Age of Mass Displacement. ESRC (2017–2022).

Teaching Experience

Queen Mary University of London 2024 – present
Seminar Leader:

- Quantitative Methods for Social Science Research
- Comparative Politics
- Political Analysis

Lebanese American University 2018 – 2019
Teaching Assistant: Introduction to Microeconomics

Research Experience

World Bank Sept 2024 – Sept 2025
Middle East & North Africa People Practice Group
Research Consultant

- Conducted econometric analysis of opinion survey microdata for flagship reports on human development and public opinion in the MENA region.
- Produced policy-facing quantitative outputs and contributed to analytical narratives for internal and external dissemination.

London School of Economics and Political Science Oct 2022 – Oct 2023
Department of Psychological & Behavioural Science
Research Assistant

- Led survey design, quantitative analysis, and manuscript preparation for a project on political polarisation and social relationships.

University College London Oct 2020 – Oct 2022
Institute for Global Prosperity
Research Assistant

- Designed and administered household surveys in Lebanon, Tanzania, and the UK.
- Oversaw fieldwork, data cleaning, and statistical analysis.

UNESCWA May 2018 – Aug 2018
Economic Affairs Intern

Peer Review

Political Studies, Electoral Studies, Political Psychology, Psychological Science

Awards

HSS PhD Scholarship, Queen Mary University of London.
Ron Johnston Methodological Training Award (EPOP).
Graduate Assistantship Scholarship, Lebanese American University.
Honours Scholarship (BSc); Valedictorian, Lebanese American University.

Conferences & Workshops	American Political Science Association (2026) Political Studies Association (2024, 2026) Elections, Public Opinion and Parties (2024, 2025) London Experimental Seminar Series in Political Science (2025) European Workshop in Empirical Political Science (2024) Midwest Political Science Association (2024)
Technical Skills	Methods: Experimental design, causal inference, survey methodology, machine learning. Software: R, Python, Stata, ArcGIS.
Languages	Arabic: Native (speaking, reading, writing) English: Fluent (speaking, reading, writing) French: Intermediate (speaking, reading, writing)